

BUSINESS SALES PERFORMANCE ANALYTICS

Future Interns – Data Science & Analytics Internship (2026)

Submitted By

Anusha Kondaguduru

Bachelor of Technology – Computer Science & Engineering

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1. Introduction

Businesses generate large volumes of transactional data daily. Analyzing this information enables organizations to understand customer purchasing behavior, monitor product performance, identify profitable market segments, and make data-driven decisions.

This project focuses on Business Sales Performance Analytics using Python for data preprocessing and Power BI for dashboard development. The goal is to transform raw sales data into meaningful insights that can support strategic business planning and operational improvements.

2. Project Objectives

The primary objectives of this project include:

- Cleaning and preparing raw sales data.
- Evaluating key business performance indicators.
- Identifying revenue and profit trends over time.

- Determining top-performing products and categories.
- Understanding customer contribution patterns.
- Assessing regional and state-wise business performance.
- Designing an interactive and client-ready Power BI dashboard.
- Providing actionable recommendations for business growth.

3. Dataset Description

Dataset Used

Sample Superstore Dataset

Dataset Features

The dataset contains transactional records related to customer purchases.

Attribute	Description
Order ID	Unique identifier
Order Date	Purchase date
Ship Date	Shipping date
Customer Name	Customer information
Segment	Customer segment
Category	Product category
Sub-Category	Product type
Product Name	Product details
Sales	Sales amount
Quantity	Units sold
Discount	Discount provided
Profit	Generated profit
Region	Sales region
State	Customer state

Dataset Summary

Total Records: **9994**

Total Columns: **21**

Date Range: **2014 – 2017**

4. Data Cleaning and Preparation

Data cleaning was performed using Python libraries such as Pandas and NumPy.

Cleaning Steps Performed

Duplicate Removal

Duplicate records were identified and removed.

```
df.drop_duplicates(inplace=True)
```

Missing Value Analysis

Missing values were checked using:

```
df.isnull().sum()
```

No significant missing values were identified.

Date Conversion

Order Date and Ship Date columns were converted into datetime format.

```
df['Order Date']=pd.to_datetime(df['Order Date'])
```

Feature Engineering

Additional variables were created.

Month

```
df['Month']=df['Order Date'].dt.month_name()
```

Year

```
df['Year']=df['Order Date'].dt.year
```

Revenue

```
df['Revenue']=df['Sales']
```

Profit Margin

```
df['Profit Margin']=(df['Profit']/df['Sales'])*100
```

5. Exploratory Data Analysis

Several analyses were conducted to evaluate business performance.

5.1 Sales Performance

The following KPIs were calculated:

Total Revenue

Measures overall business income.

Total Profit

Represents net earnings.

Total Orders

Shows transaction volume.

Average Order Value

Evaluates average spending per order.

5.2 Time Analysis

Monthly and yearly trends were analyzed to identify seasonal demand patterns.

Metrics analyzed:

- Monthly Revenue
- Yearly Revenue
- Profit Trends

5.3 Product Analysis

Product-level performance evaluation included:

Top 10 Products

Highest revenue-generating products.

Bottom 10 Products

Lowest-performing products.

Most Profitable Products

Products contributing maximum profit.

5.4 Category Analysis

Performance comparison across product categories.

Analyzed metrics:

- Sales by Category
- Profit by Category

- Sub-category Performance

5.5 Customer Analysis

Customer behavior analysis focused on:

Top Customers

Highest purchasing customers.

Customer Contribution

Percentage contribution to revenue

5.6 Regional Analysis

Regional business evaluation included:

- Revenue by Region
- Profit by Region
- State-wise Sales Distribution

6. Dashboard Development

An interactive dashboard was created using Power BI.

Dashboard Components

KPI Cards

- Total Revenue
- Total Profit
- Total Orders
- Average Order Value

Visualizations

Monthly Revenue Trend

Revenue by Category

Top Products

Profit by Region

Top Customers

State-wise Sales Map

Interactive Filters

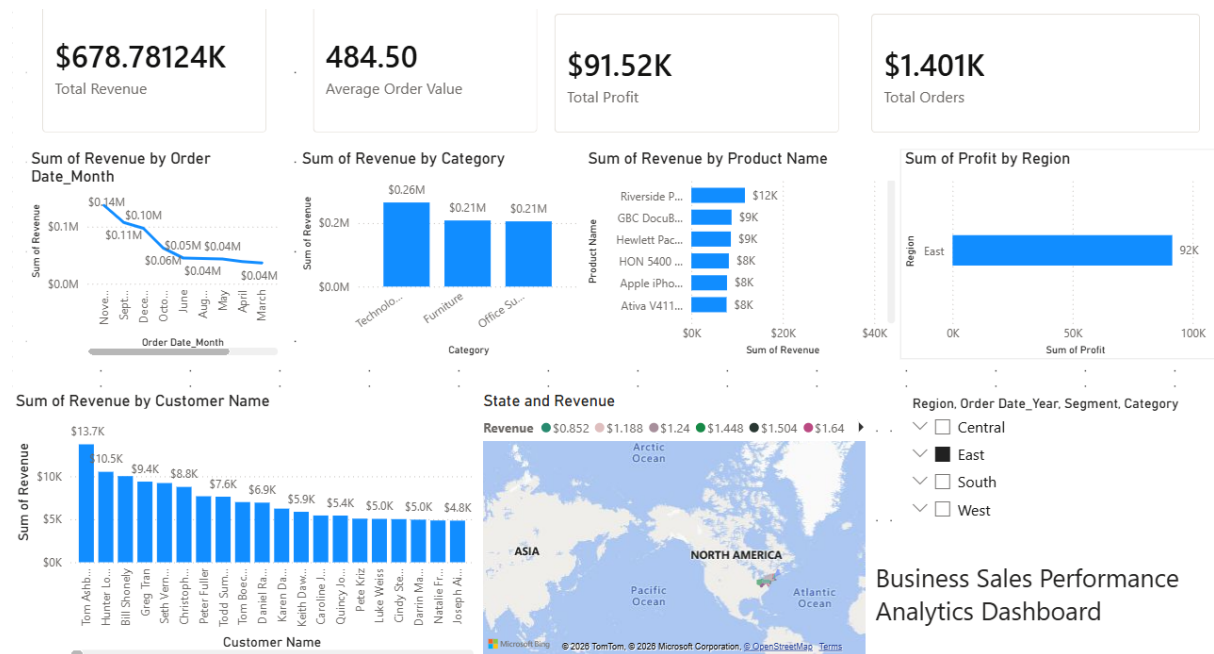
Region

Category

Segment

Year

Dashboard Screenshot:



7. Business Insights

Based on the analysis and dashboard observations, the following insights were derived:

Insight 1

Technology category generated the highest revenue among all categories.

Insight 2

The East region demonstrated strong profitability compared to other regions.

Insight 3

Sales fluctuated across months, indicating seasonal purchasing behavior.

Insight 4

A small number of products contributed significantly to overall revenue.

Insight 5

Top customers accounted for a substantial portion of total sales.

Insight 6

Regional sales performance varied considerably, presenting opportunities for targeted marketing initiatives.

Insight 7

Interactive filtering allows businesses to monitor performance dynamically across categories and regions.

8. Recommendations

Recommendation 1

Increase inventory availability for top-selling products.

Recommendation 2

Expand marketing investments in high-performing regions.

Recommendation 3

Review pricing and discount strategies for low-margin products.

Recommendation 4

Develop customer loyalty programs to retain high-value customers.

Recommendation 5

Utilize seasonal trends for inventory planning and promotional campaigns.

Recommendation 6

Continuously monitor underperforming categories and optimize product portfolios.

9. Technologies Used

Tool	Purpose
Python	Data Cleaning
Pandas	Data Manipulation
NumPy	Numerical Operations
Matplotlib	Visualization
Power BI	Dashboard Development
Excel	Dataset Handling

10. Conclusion

This project successfully demonstrates the complete data analytics lifecycle, including data preparation, exploratory analysis, dashboard creation, and business storytelling.

The Power BI dashboard provides stakeholders with an interactive platform to monitor key business indicators, identify growth opportunities, and support strategic decision-making.

The project enhanced practical competencies in Python, data visualization, KPI analysis, and business intelligence, making it highly relevant for real-world analytics roles.

11. References

- Microsoft Power BI Documentation
- Pandas Official Documentation
- NumPy Documentation
- Matplotlib Documentation
- Sample Superstore Dataset